

WITH SWAJAL PROJECT, ADANI FOUNDATION HELPS FARMERS MAKE BARREN LAND FERTILE

Kamshriben Karshanbhai Galvaa of Zarpara village in Kutch district of Gujarat turned adversity into triumph by turning her arid land into a fertile patch by digging a well and irrigating her fields. Kutch, which gets insufficient rainfall, faces the challenge of depleting water resources.

Kamshriben's initiative led to the creation of a tank that not only met her family's water needs but also supported the cultivation of crops. Witnessing the change, the community pitched in, and their cooperative effort resulted in the construction of tanks that paved the way for rain-fed agriculture in the region. This not only solved the issue of water scarcity but also provided a sustainable livelihood for many.

"The barren expanse has transformed into a flourishing agricultural landscape after we started harvesting rainwater. Most farmers in the area have chosen to live on their fields by building houses there, fostering a connection with the land and their livestock," says Kamshriben.

The Adani Foundation (AF) launched the Swajal Project at Mundra in the drought-prone region to address the alarming depletion of groundwater levels and the reduction in water sources in various parts of Kutch district. Steady depletion of ground water and frequent drought made it imperative for the Foundation and the community to work together for water conservation.

The Foundation has adopted an integrated approach for the overall development of the community through its interventions on health, education, skill development, environment biodiversity and sustainable livelihood projects. Its aim is to create a sustainable agriculture-based community.

Zarpara is one of the villages where the Foundation launched the Swajal Project. The gram panchayat, with the help of the Foundation, constructed borewells. Filtered water is now delivered to the village from a distance through these borewells. This initiative fulfills the daily water needs of the villagers, reducing their daily expenses on water and petrol. With the installation of tanks, the



cost of daily water consumption has dropped significantly from ₹40-₹60 to just ₹10-₹15. A significant monthly saving of ₹1,500 has made the availability of drinking water more affordable for everyone.

"By investing ₹10,000 on the construction of tanks, we now enjoy the sweet taste of rainwater and find joy in filling our baayu